



MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

Your first week after diagnosis.

Just found out you have histamine intolerance? Breathe. You don't have to understand everything at once.

FROM ME, TO YOU

I know exactly what the day you find out feels like. You don't have to solve it all today — this guide gives you one small step each day.

With love, Cătălina

Founder, MyHistamate

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THE BASICS

What is histamine, really?

Histamine is a substance your body produces naturally. It has important roles: it helps digestion, supports the immune system and takes part in many normal processes. It isn't the enemy.

You also get histamine from food, and some foods contain more than others. The problem isn't histamine itself, but how much builds up versus how much your body can clear.

THE KEY IDEA

We all take in and consume histamine every day. The difference is that, in histamine intolerance, the body clears it less easily and symptoms can appear sooner.

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THE BASICS

The enzyme that makes the difference: DAO

The body clears much of the histamine from food with the help of an enzyme called DAO (diamine oxidase). If DAO activity is low, histamine can build up faster than it's cleared, and symptoms can appear more easily.

Factors that can affect DAO activity:

- **Genetic predisposition**
- **Some medications**
- **Gut inflammation**
- **Alcohol consumption**

REMEMBER

Not all symptoms are caused by DAO alone. Histamine intolerance is influenced by several factors, and DAO is just one of the important pieces of the puzzle.

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THE BASICS

Where histamine shows up

Because histamine circulates everywhere, symptoms can appear in places that seem unrelated. That's why it's so hard to diagnose.

- **Head & mind**
Migraines, dizziness, brain fog, sudden fatigue.
- **Skin**
Itching, redness, hives, sudden facial flushing.
- **Nose & breathing**
Congestion, sneezing, a runny nose with no cold.
- **Heart**
Palpitations, a racing pulse, a sudden “wave” feeling.
- **Digestive**
Bloating, cramps, nausea, disrupted transit.

YOUR WEEK

Your week at a glance

One step a day. Nothing more. Tick them off at your own pace.

DAY 1

Breathe. You don't have to learn it all today.

DAY 2

Tidy up the kitchen.

DAY 3

Build your safe list.

DAY 4

Start a symptom journal.

DAY 5

Hydrate and keep regular meal times.

DAY 6

Calm the stress.

DAY 7

Plan ahead for next week.

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DAY 1

Breathe and understand

Histamine isn't an enemy. It's something your body produces and takes in daily — the problem only appears when too much builds up. In short: in histamine intolerance, the body doesn't always clear histamine fast enough. Over time it can accumulate, and symptoms can appear.

THINK OF THE “BUCKET”

Imagine a bucket. Food, stress, poor sleep and other factors fill it little by little. As long as the bucket doesn't overflow, you feel well. The goal isn't to avoid everything — it's to learn what fills your bucket and how to keep it under control.

Today, don't change anything. Just notice how you feel after meals. Tomorrow we begin, gently and without pressure.

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DAY 2

Tidy up the kitchen

Set aside (not in the bin — just to one side for a few days) the foods that usually fill the bucket fast:

- **Aged cheeses & cured meats**
The more “matured”, the more histamine.
- **Canned or stored fish**
Canned tuna is among the highest.
- **Fermented foods & alcohol**
Pickles, kombucha, wine, beer.
- **Yesterday's leftovers**
Histamine rises as food sits.

A TIP FROM ME

Don't throw anything away. Set it aside for 7–10 days. You'll reintroduce it gradually later, to see exactly what bothers you — and what you can keep.

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DAY 3

Build your safe list

Now the lovely part: what you can eat. Fill the fridge with fresh foods, cooked the same day:

- **Fresh meat & fish**
Ideally bought and cooked the same day.
- **Rice, potatoes, simple pasta**
Safe, filling sources of energy.
- **Fresh vegetables**
Cucumber, zucchini, carrot, lettuce, broccoli, potatoes.
- **Apples, pears, blueberries**
Gentle, low-histamine fruit.

A PRACTICAL TRICK

Cook larger portions and freeze whatever you don't eat right away. Freezing stops histamine from building up — so you always have a safe meal on hand.

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DAY 4

Start the journal

Memory forgets details. A journal doesn't. Write a little every day — and your patterns will surface on their own.

NOTE FIVE THINGS

What you ate. How you felt. How much you slept. Which day of your cycle you're on. How your digestion was.

That's it. Five minutes a day is enough. Example: "Lunch — chicken with rice, feeling good. Slept 7h. Day 3 of cycle. Normal digestion." It can be that simple. After a few weeks, patterns start to appear on their own — links between food, sleep, stress, cycle and symptoms.

TIPS

Don't look for conclusions after two days — the journal is a tool for patterns, not instant answers. And note the good days too: sometimes you learn more from what works than from what doesn't.

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DAY 5

Water, sleep, regular meals

Histamine isn't only about the plate. These basics make a huge difference:

- **Drink water steadily**
A glass before each meal.
- **Protect your sleep**
The body regulates histamine while you sleep.
- **Don't skip meals**
Regular meals keep the bucket steady.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Drink a glass of water as soon as you wake up. Eat at regular intervals. Try going to bed 30 minutes earlier. That's all for today.

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DAY 6

Calm the stress

Stress fills the same bucket as food. When you're on alert, your body releases more histamine. That's why a hard day can bring symptoms even if you ate "clean".

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

5 minutes of slow breathing. A short walk outside. A break without your phone. Pick at least one.

What I learned: sometimes I had symptoms on a day I'd eaten "perfectly". For a long time I thought I'd done something wrong at the table. Often, the problem was that I was exhausted, stressed or hadn't slept well. You can't control everything that happens. But you can create small pauses that keep the bucket from filling too fast.

7 DAY 7

Make a plan for ahead

You've made it through the first week. Now don't rush — healing isn't a race.

- **Keep the journal going**
Patterns become clearer over time.
- **Keep things simple**
Don't add new rules every day.
- **Be patient with yourself**
Progress matters more than perfection.

REMEMBER

Some days will be good, others harder — and that's normal. Don't look for perfection, look for patterns. Don't look for overnight solutions, look for progress. Move forward at your own pace.

FOODS · GREEN

Often well tolerated

Fresh is the key word. Generally well tolerated by many people with HIT, but individual tolerance differs.

Meat & protein

- Eggs
- Chicken
- Turkey
- Fresh beef
- Fresh pork
- Duck
- Very fresh fish

Unfermented dairy

- Butter
- Pasteurised / UHT milk
- Sweet cream
- Ricotta
- Mascarpone
- Mozzarella

Fruit

- Apples
- Pears
- Apricots
- Melon
- Watermelon
- Pomegranate
- Grapes
- Blueberries
- Currants

Vegetables

- Carrot
- Zucchini
- Cucumber
- Broccoli
- Cauliflower
- Lettuce
- Radish
- Potato & sweet potato
- Parsnip
- Pumpkin
- Asparagus

Grains & starch

- Rice
- Quinoa
- Oats
- Plain corn
- Cornflakes

Fats & seeds

- Olive oil
- Coconut oil
- Rapeseed oil
- Pumpkin
- Flax
- Psyllium
- Sesame

Herbs & teas

- Basil
- Mint
- Oregano
- Parsley
- Rosemary
- Coriander
- Cinnamon
- Honey
- Rooibos
- Linden tea

FOODS · AMBER

To test, one at a time

For these, reactions vary a lot from person to person. Worth testing one at a time, in small amounts.

Fermented dairy

- Plain yogurt
- Sour cream

Nuts & seeds

- Almonds
- Hazelnuts

Fruit & veg

- Cherries
- Plums
- Mango
- Peaches
- Avocado
- Bananas

Spices & flavours

- Ginger
- Horseradish

HOW TO TEST

Introduce one new food, in a small amount. Wait 2–3 days and note in your journal how you feel. No reaction? It's probably ok for you. Amber doesn't mean "forbidden" — it just means it's worth testing carefully.

FOODS · RED

The ones that fill the bucket fast

Fermented & aged

- Aged cheeses
- Kefir
- Pickles
- Sauerkraut
- Soy sauce
- Miso
- Tempeh

Processed meat & fish

- Salami
- Ham
- Bacon
- Cured meats
- Tuna
- Sardines
- Mackerel
- Smoked foods

Vegetables & fruit

- Tomatoes
- Spinach
- Aubergine
- Olives
- Beans
- Chickpeas
- Lentils
- Citrus
- Strawberries
- Pineapple

Other

- Chocolate / cocoa
- Wine
- Beer
- Champagne
- Prosecco
- Vinegar
- Ketchup
- Mustard
- Green & black tea
- Yeast

Red doesn't mean these foods are excluded forever. They're simply the ones that most often cause symptoms, and that many people choose to avoid in the early period.

MEAL IDEAS

Simple safe combinations

A few simple combinations, so you're never out of ideas.

- **Breakfast**

Oats + blueberries + chia · Scrambled eggs + fresh flatbread + cucumber · Chia pudding with coconut milk + blueberries · Ricotta + peach + honey.

- **Lunch**

Grilled chicken breast + rice + zucchini · Baked turkey + roast potatoes + green salad · Clear chicken soup + carrot + celery · Quinoa + grilled chicken + cucumber.

- **Dinner**

Very fresh cod + boiled potatoes + broccoli · Turkey + grilled zucchini + rice · Pumpkin soup + carrot · Simple pasta + butter + broccoli.

BONUS

5 common mistakes

- **Cutting out absolutely everything**
The shorter the list gets, the harder life gets. Start simple, not perfect.
- **Comparing yourself to others**
What works for someone else may not work for you. Your body is the best guide.
- **Ignoring freshness**
Sometimes freshness matters more than the food itself.
- **Going through it alone**
You don't have to have all the answers by yourself.
- **Wanting overnight results**
Patterns appear over time. Give your body a few weeks, not a few days.

CHECKLIST

Your first week

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- ☐ I understood the “bucket” concept
 - ☐ I tidied up the kitchen
 - ☐ I have a list of safe foods
 - ☐ I started a daily journal
 - ☐ I drink water & sleep better
 - ☐ I have a plan with my doctor

COMING SOON

Soon, you won't have to guess

I'm building the MyHistamate app because I wish it had existed when I started. You note your day, and the app finds your correlations between food, sleep, stress and symptoms. Not general rules, but patterns specific to your case.

- **An easy-to-use journal**
Note your day in a few seconds.
- **Personalised patterns & correlations**
See what shows up before the symptoms.
- **Photograph the menu**
Find out on the spot what you can order.

JOIN THE WAITING LIST

Be among the first to try it. Sign up free at myhistamate.com and I'll let you know the moment we launch.

You're on the right path.

A bad day doesn't erase your progress. Learn your bucket, be patient with yourself and celebrate the small steps.

[Discover MyHistamate](#)

This guide is for informational purposes only and does not replace professional medical advice. Histamine intolerance varies greatly from person to person — always consult your doctor before making significant changes to your diet or treatment.